Ramy Lawi Guiling

Atty. Ramy "Mohammad Sedic" Lawi Guiling Al-Haj is a Filipino jurist, educator, businessman, and member of the Royal Sultanates of Lanao, best known for his long career as a Regional State Prosecutor of the Department of Justice for the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM), now the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM). Over the decades, he built a reputation not just as a careful and principled prosecutor, but as a teacher, orator, and quiet pillar of the Meranaw community.

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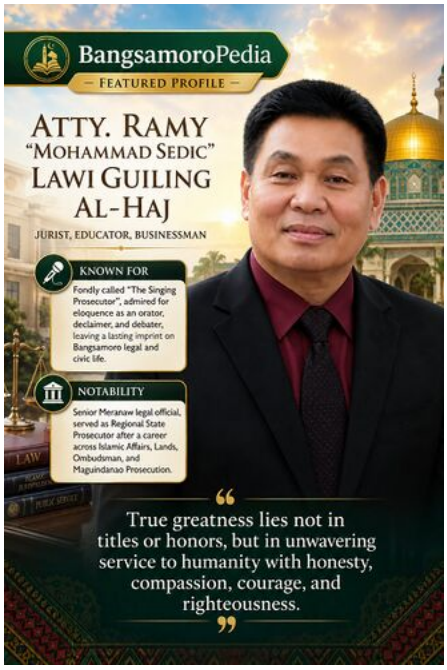
Early Life and Education

Atty. Guiling comes from a lineage deeply rooted in the traditional leadership of Lanao. He is the son of Sultan of Masiu Guiling O. Buntalis Al-Haj and Sitte Nafsia Dehaliya Lawi Guiling Al-Hadja, herself the daughter of Sultan of Masiu Lawi Belok Osangan. He is also a grandson of Sultan Mamatod of Gapa, Balindong, placing him firmly within a family whose name carries weight across several Meranaw sultanates.

He pursued his college education at Manuel L. Quezon University (MLQU), where he completed his Bachelor of Arts in Political Science in 1973, finishing the program in just seven semesters instead of the usual eight, a small detail that already hinted at the discipline he would carry into the rest of his career. He stayed on at the same university for law school, earning his Bachelor of Laws in 1977.

The following year, in 1978, he took and passed the Philippine Bar Examinations, landing among the Top 20 Bar Passers nationwide. He also posted a perfect score of 100% in Civil Law, a rare feat that said

Atty. Ramy "Mohammad Sedic" Lawi Guiling Al-Haj



Occupation

Regional State Prosecutor, Department of Justice (ARMM/BARMM); lawyer, educator, businessman

Education

Manuel L. Quezon University (AB Political Science, 1973; Bachelor of Laws, 1977)

Bar Admission

Philippine Bar Examinations, 1978 (Top 20 Bar Passer; perfect score in Civil Law)

Spouse

Bae Norania Laut Al-Hadja

Parents

Sultan of Masiu Guiling O. Buntalis Al-Haj and Sitte Nafsia Dehaliya Lawi Guiling Al-Hadja

Heritage

Royal Sultanates of Lanao: Masiu, Borocot, and Bansayan

Notability

One of the highest-ranking Meranaw legal officials to serve as Regional State Prosecutor, capping a government career that spanned the Department of Islamic Affairs, the Bureau of Lands, the Office of the Ombudsman, and the Provincial Prosecutor's Office of Maguindanao.

Known For

as much about his grasp of legal principle as it did about the hours he must have poured into mastering it.

Fondly called "The Singing Prosecutor" for his artistic gifts, and widely admired as an orator, declaimer, and debater whose eloquence left a lasting mark on Bangsamoro legal and civic circles.

Pull Quote

"True greatness is measured not merely by titles, honors, or professional accomplishments, but by a steadfast commitment to serving humanity with honesty, compassion, courage, and righteousness."

Career in Public Service

Atty. Guiling's government service began in 1978 with the Department of Islamic Affairs under the Department of Foreign Affairs (DFA), a fitting starting point given his background and faith. From there, his career moved steadily through a series of demanding posts: District Land Officer of the Bureau of Lands in Iligan City, City Prosecutor of Marawi, Deputy Ombudsman for Mindanao, and Provincial Prosecutor of Maguindanao.

He eventually rose to become Regional State Prosecutor of the Department of Justice for the ARMM (now BARMM), a position he held until his compulsory retirement, closing out a government career that spanned several decades and touched nearly every layer of the justice system in the region.

Legal Practice and Advocacy

Outside of government, Atty. Guiling also built a respected private legal practice. Among the cases that stand out in his career was his work representing victims and their families in litigation connected to the SuperFerry tragedy, many of whom were Maranao passengers. It was work that called for more than legal skill: it demanded patience and compassion for families still grappling with loss, and Atty. Guiling took on that responsibility with evident seriousness.

Academic Career

Convinced that legal knowledge should never stay locked away in the courtroom, Atty. Guiling also spent years teaching. He served as a professor at St. Michael's College, at Jamiatu Philippine Al-Islamia (JPI) in Marawi City, and at the Mindanao State University College of Law. Generations of law students passed through his classes, many of them carrying forward the same values he emphasized: competence, integrity, ethical leadership, and respect for the rule of law.

Personal Life

Atty. Guiling is married to Bae Norania Laut Al-Hadja, daughter of Sheik Ismael Laut, the Sultan of Rogan and a former Senior Board Member of Lanao del Sur from Poon A Bayabao. Together they raised a family grounded in faith, honor, and service to their community.

Away from the courtroom and the classroom, Atty. Guiling is also a successful businessman with a taste for golf, tennis, and precision shooting, pursuits that reflect the same discipline and focus he brought to his legal career.

Royal Heritage and Recognition

As a member of the Royal Sultanates of Lanao, Atty. Guiling carries a heritage tied to Masiu and, through his family line, to Gapa, Balindong. In recognition of his leadership, integrity, and years of distinguished service, he has been honored by three Royal Sultanates of Lanao: Masiu, Borocot, and Bansayan, a distinction that reflects the esteem in which he is held by both traditional and modern institutions in the region.

Public Image

Beyond his legal and academic credentials, Atty. Guiling is known across Lanao for his charisma and artistic talent, earning him the affectionate nickname "The Singing Prosecutor." He has also long been admired as a skilled orator, declaimer, and debater, qualities that made him a memorable and commanding presence at gatherings throughout his career.

Legacy

Atty. Ramy "Mohammad Sedic" Lawi Guiling Al-Haj's career reflects a rare combination: a jurist's precision, a teacher's patience, and a performer's warmth. From his early academic distinctions to his decades in public service and legal practice, his story continues to serve as an example for lawyers, prosecutors, judges, and educators across the Bangsamoro region, a reminder that a life of service can be measured in integrity as much as in title.

See Also

- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Royal Sultanates of Lanao
- Department of Justice (Philippines)

References

- Family-compiled biographical account of Atty. Ramy "Mohammad Sedic" Lawi Guiling Al-Haj, provided by the family and cross-checked for accuracy.

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